

dictionaries, which became standard in the Python language in 3.7. But just because a dictionary is ordered doesn't mean that its items are accessible through integer indexes: `spam[0]` won't evaluate to the first item in an ordered dictionary (unless by coincidence there is a key `0` for the first item). Ordered dictionaries are also considered the same if they contain the same key-value pairs, even if the key-value pairs are in a different order in each dictionary.

The `collections` module contains many other mapping types, including `OrderedDict`, `ChainMap`, `Counter`, and `UserDict`, which are described in the online documentation at <https://docs.python.org/3/library/collections.html>.

Dunder Methods and Magic Methods

Dunder methods, also called *magic methods*, are special methods in Python whose names begin and end with two underscores. These methods are used for operator overloading. *Dunder* is short for double underscore. The most familiar dunder method is `__init__()` (pronounced “dunder init dunder,” or simply “init”), which initializes objects. Python has a few dozen dunder methods, and Chapter 17 explains them in detail.

Modules and Packages

A *module* is a Python program that other Python programs can import so they can use the module's code. The modules that come with Python are collectively called the *Python Standard Library*, but you can create your own modules as well. If you save a Python program as, for example, `spam.py`, other programs can run `import spam` to access the `spam.py` program's functions, classes, and top-level variables.

A *package* is a collection of modules that you form by placing a file named `__init__.py` inside a folder. You use the folder's name as the name of the package. Packages can contain multiple modules (that is, `.py` files) or other packages (other folders containing `__init__.py` files).

For more explanation and detail about modules and packages, check out the official Python documentation at <https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/modules.html>.